

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Thursday 20 August 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 22 August 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A cold front clears to the east Wednesday evening. Weak troughs clip the southeast in a broad westerly flow on Thursday and Friday, as a ridge of high pressure is expected to approach South Australia from the west. The high centre is expected to linger over the state on the weekend.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming easterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: North to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly below 10 knots in the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: South to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly in the late morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots in the west during the morning. Winds turning southwesterly in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: West to southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres in the west. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to below 10 knots during the morning then becoming north to northeasterly during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Strong Wind Warning for Thursday for South Central Coast

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 25 knots, reaching up to 30 knots during the morning. Winds turning westerly in the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre later in the evening. Swell: Westerly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to below 10 knots during the day then becoming north to northwesterly during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, decreasing below 0.5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots south of Salt Creek in the late morning. Winds turning westerly in the middle of the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Westerly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres south of Salt Creek. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres south of Salt Creek. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to below 10 knots during the day then becoming north to northwesterly during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, decreasing below 0.5 metres during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres south of Salt Creek. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres south of Port MacDonnell. Swell: Westerly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots south of Port MacDonnell in the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres south of Port MacDonnell. Swell: Westerly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres during the morning, then tending southwesterly 4 metres later in the evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 25 knots tending northwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly in the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon then decreasing to about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 20 August until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Westerly 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then tending west to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 22 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.